

VIBHOR AGARWAL

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EDUCATION

University of Surrey

Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science

July 2021 - Present

Surrey, England, UK

The LNM Institute Of Information Technology

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering

August 2016 - June 2020

Jaipur, India

Overall GPA: 9.45/10

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

GraphNLI: A Graph-based Natural Language Inference Model for Polarity Prediction in Online Debates The ACM Web Conference (WWW) 2022

Vibhor Agarwal, Sagar Joglekar, Anthony P. Young, Nishanth Sastry

- Developed a novel Graph-based deep learning model to predict the argumentative relations of *attack* and *support* (polarities) in online debates.
- GraphNLI leverages neighboring context in online discussions through graph walks, along with the local context, and has wide applications in NLP field, such as Recognizing Textual Entailment.

“Way back then”: A Data-driven View of 25+ years of Web Evolution

WWW 2022

Vibhor Agarwal, Nishanth Sastry

- An exploratory data analysis and measurement study to quantify how the Web has evolved, by leveraging historical data crawled from *Archive.org*, *Google Trends*, and *Alexa*.

AnnoBERT: Effective Representation of Multiple Annotators’ Perspectives and Label Semantics for Hate Speech Detection ICWSM 2023

Vibhor Agarwal, Wenjie Yin, Aiqi Jiang, Arkaitz Zubiaga, Nishanth Sastry

- Model different annotators’ perspectives using Collaborative Topic Regression in subjective tasks such as Hate Speech detection.
- AnnoBERT fuses annotator perspectives and label semantics to improve Hate Speech detection.

A Graph-Based Context-Aware Model to Understand Online Conversations Submitted to the Transactions on the Web (TWEB) 2023

Vibhor Agarwal, Anthony P. Young, Sagar Joglekar, Nishanth Sastry

- This work is a journal extension of GraphNLI work in which we improved the framework and proved the generalizability of the framework by evaluating it on the hate speech detection task as well, apart from polarity prediction.

GASCOM: Graph-based Attentive Semantic Context Modeling for Online Conversation Understanding Submitted to CIKM 2023

Vibhor Agarwal, Yu Chen, Nishanth Sastry

- We propose GASCOM and design two novel *semantic-aware graph-based conversation context selection algorithms* for retrieving relevant context nodes which consider both the graph structure and semantic meanings of the conversation context.
- We further design a *token-level multi-head graph attention mechanism* to pay different attentions to different tokens from the selected context utterances for fine-grained conversation context modeling.

Improving the Detection of Multilingual Online Attacks with Rich Social Media Data from Singapore ACL 2023

Janosch Haber, Bertie Vidgen, Matthew Chapman, Vibhor Agarwal, Roy Ka-Wei Lee, Yong Keong Yap, Paul Röttger

Decentralized Moderation in the Fediverse: A Conversation Approach Submitted to ICWSM 2024

Vibhor Agarwal, Aravindh Raman, Ahmed Sayed, Gareth Tyson, Nishanth Sastry, Ignacio Castro

Under the Spotlight: Web Tracking in Indian Partisan News Websites ICWSM 2021

Vibhor Agarwal, Yash Vekaria, Pushkal Agarwal, Sangeeta Mahapatra, Shounak Set, Sakthi Balan Muthiah, Nishanth Sastry, Nicolas Kourtellis

- Collected the dataset of traffic information using OpenWPM for the Indian news websites.
- Implemented various Privacy Metrics such as Canvas Fingerprinting, Cookie Synchronization, and Invisible Pixels to measure the extent of tracking across partisan news websites.

Differential Tracking Across Topical Webpages of Indian News Media WebSci 2021

Yash Vekaria, Vibhor Agarwal, Pushkal Agarwal, Sangeeta Mahapatra, Sakthi Balan, Nishanth Sastry, Nicolas Kourtellis

- Studied differential tracking across different news topics in Indian News Websites and found preferential attachment of trackers towards specific topics.
- Developed DiBETS, a novel machine learning methodology, to automatically classify webpage URLs into news topics.

A Metadata-based Event Detection Method using Temporal Herding Factor and Social Synchrony on Twitter Data RCIS 2021

Nirmal Sivaraman, Vibhor Agarwal, Yash Vekaria, Sakthi Balan Muthiah

- Research project to analyse and detect social synchronies and thereafter, to detect online events from these detected synchronies on Twitter dataset.
- A social synchrony is a social phenomenon where many people perform a similar action in unison over a short period of time. Dataset used is a time-series dataset of tweets on daily basis collected using Twitter API.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Georgia Institute of Technology Jul 2023 - Present
Visiting Researcher Atlanta, Georgia, USA

- I am working on automatically detecting and combating hallucinations in Large Language Models.

Queen Mary University of London Oct 2022 - Apr 2023
Visiting Researcher London, UK

- I worked on understanding online conversations in the decentralized platforms such as Mastodon and Pleroma and studied how these conversations evolve and federate over different instances. I also proposed various moderation strategies for hate speech in decentralized conversations.

Rewire Online Jul 2022 - Sep 2022
NLP Research Internship London, UK

- I worked on a research project, funded by DSO Singapore, to detect online abuse in code-switched languages such as Singlish and low-resource languages such as Malay and Indonesian.
- Crawled multilingual dataset of online abuse from Reddit and developed machine learning models to detect abusive language.

The Alan Turing Institute

Visiting Researcher, Data Study Group

Jul 2021 - Sep 2021

London, UK

- In this Data Study Group, organized by Turing Institute and University of Leeds, UK, I worked on a research project to predict Vet-AI's demands, which is an AI powered research company for Pets' healthcare.

Media.net (Directi)

Site Reliability Engineer

Jan 2020 - Jun 2021

Mumbai, India

- Media.Net is a leading contextual advertising tech company.
- As full-time employee, I led lots of projects. The largest among them was to optimise the Machine Learning pipeline of a Keyword Recommender model and integrate it with TensorFlow Extended.
- The Keyword Recommender model, using the context of a webpage, suggests keywords for which ads can be shown on webpages.

SLK Software

Software Engineering Internship

May 2019 - Jul 2019

Bangalore, India

- Built a cross-platform desktop application using Electron and ReactJS to analyse Java applications.
- Given the project path as input, the application can generate its corresponding Class Diagram and Data-Flow Diagram for class analysis and properties like inheritance. It also finds the dead code, unused variables, duplicate imports and other problems in the project.
- Technologies used - JavaScript (ReactJS, Electron, Node.js), Python, and MongoDB.

Google Summer of Code 2018 — The Oppia Foundation

Open Source Developer

May 2018 - Aug 2018

Remote

- Oppia aims at building interactive platform for both lesson creators and learners and brings learning freely available in the interesting and story telling way.
- Implemented two new interactions – “Number with units” and “Drag and drop sort” to enhance the learning experience of the students and help creators in making effective lessons.
- Technologies used - JavaScript (AngularJS, JQuery), Python, and Google Cloud.

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- Presented my poster at **ELLIS Cambridge Summer School** in July 2022.
- Received **Ultimate Web Science Quiz Award** at ACM WebSci 2021.
- Received funded **PhD studentship** at University of Surrey, UK.
- Received the **Best Bachelor's Thesis Award** in the graduated class of 2020 at LNMIIT, Jaipur, India.
- Awarded **PyCon US scholarship** to attend the largest Python Conference in 2020 and 2022 and present my poster titled, "Video Surveillance System for Female Security using Keras".
- **Quarter finalist in India Innovation Challenge Design Contest' 2018** organised by Department of Science and Technology and IIM Bangalore for our robust 'Pro-active Video Surveillance System'.
- **Awarded Meritorious Certification and Scholarship** for securing position in top 1 percentile at LNMIIT, Jaipur.
- Awarded **Certificate of Appreciation** for **Google Summer of Code' 18** at LNMIIT, Jaipur.
- Earned **Silver Medal** at **State level Mental ability competition (Abacus)**.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages	Python, JavaScript, C, Java, MATLAB
Artificial Intelligence	Machine Learning, Deep Learning, NLP
Tools	PyTorch, Keras, Scikit-Learn, Numpy, Pandas, Matplotlib, and Seaborn
Frameworks	Flask (Python), AngularJS, ReactJS, Electron, and Node.js (JavaScript)
Database	MySQL, SQLite and MongoDB and Redis (NoSQL)
Version Control	Git and GitHub

OPEN SOURCE

Data Version Control (DVC) Jul 2019 - Nov 2019

- DVC is an open-source version control for Data Science and Machine Learning projects.
- Mostly contributed to the technical documentation of the project and made bug fixes in the code.

The Oppia Foundation Sep 2017 - Jul 2019

- Contributed to this great Google's open source project for almost two years.
- Was part of core developer's team, implemented new features and helped new Geeks in getting started with the basics. Was also a **maintainer** keeping track of the Pull Requests.

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

Lab Demonstrator, University of Surrey, UK Sep 2021 - Present

- Served as a Teaching Assistant in NLP and Computational Intelligence labs and helped Master's students in understanding and implementing the NLP concepts using Python.

Data Science Lead — Computer Society of India (LNMIIT Chapter) Aug 2018 - May 2019
Computer Society of India (CSI) is the first and the largest body of computer professionals in India.

- Guided engineering students in accomplishing Data Science projects and conducted various workshops and research talks related to state-of-the-art algorithms in ML and Data Science.

Google Code-In 2018 Mentor May 2018 - Aug 2018

- Selected as the mentor in GCI 2018 program to guide school students to contribute in open source projects under **JBoss (RedHat)** organization.